

Scene 5: The Imprisoned Knight

TIME

~10-15 minutes

PURPOSE

Show FAITHFULNESS • Provide boss intel • Meaningful choice • Tougher combat

THE DISCOVERY

Heavy iron doors to keep, flanked by 2 Corrupted Guards. But before you can approach...

A voice, weak but defiant, from barred window at ground level. Basement cell beside entrance. Through narrow window: figure in tattered armor, chained to wall. Despite everything, sits upright, head unbowed.

Guards haven't noticed you yet - moment to approach window.

Constance (looks up, surprised):

Who...? You're not from here. [Eyes focus on Blade] Is that... the Blade of Righteous Judgment? By the King, it IS. Then it's finally happening. The Order hasn't forgotten us after all.

CONSTANCE'S STORY

'My name is Constance. I was captain of the city guard when Dorogh came. I tried to defend the city, rallied the guards to fight. We failed. Most died or were corrupted, twisted into his service.

Dorogh keeps me alive as a warning. Parades me before the people, chained and beaten, to break their hope.

But I won't break. I won't.'

CRUCIAL INTELLIGENCE

'Dorogh seems invincible. I've seen warriors charge him with every weapon - swords, hammers, arrows. Nothing touches him. He laughs as blades bounce off.

But when I faced him, I SAW him. Not with my eyes, but with my heart. I saw the corruption eating at him, the lies Drachan fed him. For just a moment, I saw the man he used to be.

That's when he struck me down. He screamed, "Don't look at me like that!" Like truth itself was a weapon.

If you can see through his corruption, truly SEE him, maybe that's when he's vulnerable. Maybe that's when the Blade can strike.

His guards will come first - two of them inside, corrupted things. Save your strength for Dorogh.'

THE CHOICE

FREE HER NOW (loud):

- Might to smash chains (14+) or Lockpicks (12+)
- Guards hear, combat starts immediately
- Constance helps in fight (weakened: -2 to rolls, but gives party +1 inspiration)
- After: 'Thank you. Now go. I'll guard the door.'

PROMISE TO RETURN (quiet):

- 'Good. Smart. Don't waste strength on me. I've waited this long.

Promise me: when you strike him down, remember he wasn't always a monster. Show him mercy at the end if you can. Let him remember what he was.'

- Quieter approach, save strength for boss

COMBAT: CORRUPTED GUARDS (if needed)

Corrupted Guard 1: HP: ☐☐☐ Armor: ☐

Corrupted Guard 2: HP: ☐☐☐ Armor: ☐

GUARD STATS

Defense Threshold: 18 • Attack Threshold: 13

Armor: Yes (must break first) • Resistances: Heart

Silent, relentless, fight to death. Empty eyes - humanity gone.

Teaches: Armor mechanic, resistance mechanic, higher difficulty

ENTERING THE KEEP

Heavy doors swing open. Inside: cold, dark. Torches burn with strange dim light that pulls shadows. You feel Dorogh's presence pressing down like physical weight. Blade is so cold it almost burns.

Stone stairs climb upward toward throne room. This is it.

Players can heal/prepare. When ready: climb toward Dorogh.

IF FREED CONSTANCE

'Remember - see through the corruption! That's the key! And... thank you. Whatever happens, thank you for giving me hope again.'